argue that ‘diplomacy cannot be practised simultaneously at the marketplace and in the chancelleries’[56] but diplomacy in a democracy means that the public will often force the government to take decisions based not on logic but on emotion. The media, both old and new, is thus a key medium for agenda setting and framing which issues will be prominent in the eyes of the public.

The growing involvement of the media and public opinion in foreign policy led the Ministry of External Affairs to set up a public diplomacy division in 2006. In recent years the MEA has become increasingly active on social media, both Facebook and especially Twitter. Both Prime Minister Modi and External Affairs Minister Sushma Swaraj are extremely active on twitter and the latter especially has been extremely responsive to queries and calls for help from the Indian diaspora around the world.

An insular focused system of institutions with a permanent bureaucracy that is reluctant to accept outside expertise has meant that for decades there was an absence of think tanks and external research institutions in India. It is only in recent years that these institutions have developed, and still more recent for them to be privately funded. Even though India has a number of well-regarded universities, significant discussions in these academic institutions on foreign policy issues has been negligible.

One area in which it has been easier to accept outside expertise is the economic arena. Economic foreign policy has been an area that the government has been slow to enter and has allowed private entities, including the corporate sector to play a role. Indian business organizations like the Federation of Indian Chambers of Commerce and Industry (FICCI), Associated Chambers of Commerce and Industry of India (ASSOCHAM) and Confederation of Indian Industry (CII) have played a role in economic foreign policy right from the 1950s and have been accepted as collaborators by the various ministries.